

# Facilitator Guide

## *Walk Before Me: A Journey Through Psalm 26*

Emmaus Road Study Series · Seven sessions

Build: August 27, 2026 · Template proof, session content pending

### Before You Lead

This guide carries the shape of a session, not a script. The Holy Spirit is the teacher (John 14:26). The guide, the handout, the app and every other instrument are tools, and a tool that starts being trusted as a teacher has become a Nehushtan (2 Kings 18:4). Say so plainly at the first session and mean it.

1. Read the whole psalm aloud once before the first session, out of your own Bible.
2. Work the passage yourself before you work the guide. Bring what you found, not what you read here.
3. Pray before you open the book. The prayer on the Student Handout is the one the table prays together.
4. Check the guards for the session. Each one exists because the text can be misread at that point.
5. Never pre-read the verse to the table from this guide. They read it from their own Bibles. That rule is not a formality; it is how a table learns to feed itself.

### The Seven Sessions

|     | Session       | Passage       | Core Question                                                    |
|-----|---------------|---------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|
| I   | The Appeal    | Psalm 26:1-3  | Does the walk begin with our strength, or His name?              |
| II  | The Refusal   | Psalm 26:4-5  | Is integrity a claim of sinlessness, or a plea for preservation? |
| III | The Ritual    | Psalm 26:6-7  | Which holds the man: the walk, or the trust?                     |
| IV  | The Affection | Psalm 26:8    | Do we open the inner rooms to the One we trust?                  |
| V   | The Petition  | Psalm 26:9-10 | Where does our integrity meet His mercy?                         |
| VI  | The Resolve   | Psalm 26:11   | What does a resolve born of dependence look like in our week?    |
| VII | The Stand     | Psalm 26:12   | When does private integrity become public praise?                |

# Session I. The Appeal

*Psalm 26:1-3 · also known as Covenant Ground*

## Open

Prayer, then the reading. Have someone at the table read the passage aloud from their own Bible. Do not read it for them.

## Read

**Read: Psalm 26:1-3. Companion witness: Genesis 17:1 (outside Psalm 26).**

## The Turn

*David opens by inviting God's scrutiny, a bold declaration of transparency.*

*The one thing this session must land. From the notebook pages.*

## Ask

- Does the walk begin with our strength, or His name?

*Two or three further questions from the notebook pages. Reader-facing, open, answerable from the text.*

## Guard

*The misreading this passage invites, and the sentence that heads it off. Say it aloud even if nobody asks.*

## Close

Name the next passage so the table can read ahead. Close in prayer.

## Session II. The Refusal

*Psalm 26:4-5 · also known as The Prayer Beneath*

### Open

Prayer, then the reading. Have someone at the table read the passage aloud from their own Bible. Do not read it for them.

### Read

**Read: Psalm 26:4-5. Companion witness: Psalm 25:21 (outside Psalm 26).**

### The Turn

*A conscious, deliberate separation from the deceitful and wicked.*

*The one thing this session must land. From the notebook pages.*

### Ask

- Is integrity a claim of sinlessness, or a plea for preservation?

*Two or three further questions from the notebook pages. Reader-facing, open, answerable from the text.*

### Guard

*The misreading this passage invites, and the sentence that heads it off. Say it aloud even if nobody asks.*

### Close

Name the next passage so the table can read ahead. Close in prayer.

## Session III. The Ritual

*Psalm 26:6-7 · also known as The Walk and The Trust*

### Open

Prayer, then the reading. Have someone at the table read the passage aloud from their own Bible. Do not read it for them.

### Read

**Read: Psalm 26:6-7. Companion witness: Psalm 26:1, 3.**

### The Turn

*Washing hands in innocence to approach the altar of the Lord.*

*The one thing this session must land. From the notebook pages.*

### Ask

- Which holds the man: the walk, or the trust?

*Two or three further questions from the notebook pages. Reader-facing, open, answerable from the text.*

### Guard

*The misreading this passage invites, and the sentence that heads it off. Say it aloud even if nobody asks.*

### Close

Name the next passage so the table can read ahead. Close in prayer.

## Session IV. The Affection

*Psalm 26:8 · also known as The Door Opened*

### Open

Prayer, then the reading. Have someone at the table read the passage aloud from their own Bible. Do not read it for them.

### Read

**Read: Psalm 26:8. Companion witness: Psalm 26:2.**

### The Turn

*A profound, emotional declaration of love for God's dwelling place.*

*The one thing this session must land. From the notebook pages.*

### Ask

- Do we open the inner rooms to the One we trust?

*Two or three further questions from the notebook pages. Reader-facing, open, answerable from the text.*

### Guard

*The misreading this passage invites, and the sentence that heads it off. Say it aloud even if nobody asks.*

### Close

Name the next passage so the table can read ahead. Close in prayer.

## Session V. The Petition

*Psalm 26:9-10 · also known as The Petition*

### Open

Prayer, then the reading. Have someone at the table read the passage aloud from their own Bible. Do not read it for them.

### Read

**Read: Psalm 26:9-10. Companion witness: Psalm 26:9-11.**

### The Turn

*A desperate plea to not be gathered with sinners.*

*The one thing this session must land. From the notebook pages.*

### Ask

- Where does our integrity meet His mercy?

*Two or three further questions from the notebook pages. Reader-facing, open, answerable from the text.*

### Guard

*The misreading this passage invites, and the sentence that heads it off. Say it aloud even if nobody asks.*

### Close

Name the next passage so the table can read ahead. Close in prayer.

## Session VI. The Resolve

*Psalm 26:11 · also known as The Resolve*

### Open

Prayer, then the reading. Have someone at the table read the passage aloud from their own Bible. Do not read it for them.

### Read

**Read: Psalm 26:11. Companion witness: Psalm 26:11.**

### The Turn

*A renewed commitment to integrity and a cry for redemption.*

*The one thing this session must land. From the notebook pages.*

### Ask

- What does a resolve born of dependence look like in our week?

*Two or three further questions from the notebook pages. Reader-facing, open, answerable from the text.*

### Guard

*The misreading this passage invites, and the sentence that heads it off. Say it aloud even if nobody asks.*

### Close

Name the next passage so the table can read ahead. Close in prayer.

## Session VII. The Stand

*Psalm 26:12 · also known as The Even Place*

### Open

Prayer, then the reading. Have someone at the table read the passage aloud from their own Bible. Do not read it for them.

### Read

**Read: Psalm 26:12. Companion witness: Psalm 26:12.**

### The Turn

*The final destination: standing firmly on level ground, praising the Lord.*

*The one thing this session must land. From the notebook pages.*

### Ask

- When does private integrity become public praise?

*Two or three further questions from the notebook pages. Reader-facing, open, answerable from the text.*

### Guard

*The misreading this passage invites, and the sentence that heads it off. Say it aloud even if nobody asks.*

### Close

Name the next passage so the table can read ahead. Close in prayer.



## Guards That Stand Across All Seven

| Guard                                   | Basis                                                                                                                                                         |
|-----------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Integrity is not sinlessness            | The app commentary on Psalm 26:11 states it directly: the claim of integrity is not a claim of sinlessness, and the immediate follow-up is the cry redeem me. |
| God knows hearts, He does not read them | Project instruction, standing globally. Psalm 26:2 asks God to try the reins and the heart. Omniscience, not inference.                                       |
| God proves, He does not tempt with evil | Project instruction from James 1:13, standing globally. Psalm 26:2 is a plea to be examined and proved.                                                       |
| Remez requires New Testament warrant    | Project instruction. Any forward reading from Psalm 26 needs an explicit cross-reference, or it is held back.                                                 |

## If the Table Goes Sideways

- Someone answers from a commentary instead of the text. Ask where in the passage they see it. If it is not there, it is held back.
- Someone hears integrity as sinlessness. Go to the psalm's own next line, the cry redeem me, and let the text correct the reading.
- Someone treats the app, this guide or a teacher as the authority. Name the Nehushtan principle and go back to the book.
- Nobody speaks. Read the passage a second time, slowly, and wait. Silence after a reading is not a failure.

## Validation Status

Template proof. Session structure, the seven passages, the core questions and the guards are transcribed from the study data and the standing project instructions. Every teaching slot is empty pending the notebook pages. No interpretive content has been written.